

All of that being said and despite the fact that there are not enough services and resources to support women with investing, we are more than capable of taking things into our own hands. We can change the statistics and narratives about women and investing for the better, not just for ourselves but for our children, too.

As a woman, it's important to understand that taking advantage of the time you have right now to invest and put your money to work for you is key to building long-term wealth and achieving your financial goals, including living out a retirement that you'll enjoy.

Yes, saving cash in the bank is great for emergencies, upcoming planned expenses, and short-term goals. But when it comes to beating inflation and earning enough returns to grow your money, you are going to need to invest. Keep in mind that since we live longer on average than men, we will most likely need more money to support our future selves when we get older. And whether or not we live longer than our male counterparts, many women are choosing to remain single or are single as a result of a relationship that did not work out, divorce, or the loss of a spouse. This in turn means many of us are navigating our finances as single mothers and sole household earners, making it more important than ever for us to be in charge of our finances.

Investing strategically for growth and being less conservative if you have a long timeline can also have a huge impact on your ability to build wealth. Don't get me wrong, investing conservatively is absolutely not a bad thing, neither is having a mix of risk levels in your investment portfolio. However, there is definitely opportunity to build *more* wealth by being strategically more aggressive, especially when you have time on your side and your goals are long-term. It may feel riskier, and it's true that the market could take a downturn, but having a long-term horizon helps to mitigate the risk because you're investing with time for recovery and growth.

Over time, investing can help you overcome the impact of the wage gap, especially when done consistently. The effect of compounding on your investment returns and earned dividends can greatly amplify the growth of your portfolio. Once you get started with investing, things tend to snowball (in a good way). But sometimes getting started is the hardest part.